

disc. The widespread adoption of electric microphones, signal amplifiers and disc cutting machines by major recording labels in 1925 ushered in the electronic era. This was quickly replaced by sound on film, where a separate audio strip on the edge of film negative opened up the doors for multi-tracking. One of the most famous examples of such a composite sound is the Tarzan yell. It was also during this period that the loudspeaker was invented, which has remained virtually unchanged till date in the playback mechanism. The only major changes have happened in the recording side and of course audio conversion methods.

From 1950 onwards, magnetic tape, a German technology discovered by the Allies after the Second world war, quickly became the medium of choice for audio master recording, and led to the development of the first hi-fi stereo recordings for the domestic market, along with the development of multi-track tape recording for music, and the demise of the disc as the primary mastering medium for sound.

Since 1975 till date, digital audio has almost replaced all previous forms and formats almost entirely, mainly pioneered by Sony in Japan in the 1970s. The advent of compact discs (CDs) cemented the dominance of digital audio as it provided audio quality, fidelity and durability never heard and seen before. What's ironic is that the CDs departure was also heralded by the digital audio; specifically file formats (.wav, mp3 etc) that brought a great degree of compression and were boosted by digital distribution innovations such as Apple's iTunes.

Currently we live in an era of streaming where these digital files are available over high speed internet connections to be played on most devices of your choice. And talking about devices in the world of audio, there are quite a few that are used for a multitude of purposes.

HEAVY DUTY

Before we get on to the everyday stuff, it's important to know what does not fall into the realm of audio technology for an average user, and a little bit about how that side of the world of audio technology works.

Loudspeakers or studio monitor

The first thing that comes to anyone's mind when audio technology is mentioned are loudspeakers. While Chapter 2 talks about these in more details, understanding their basic structure and functionality here is crucial to go forward in this chapter.